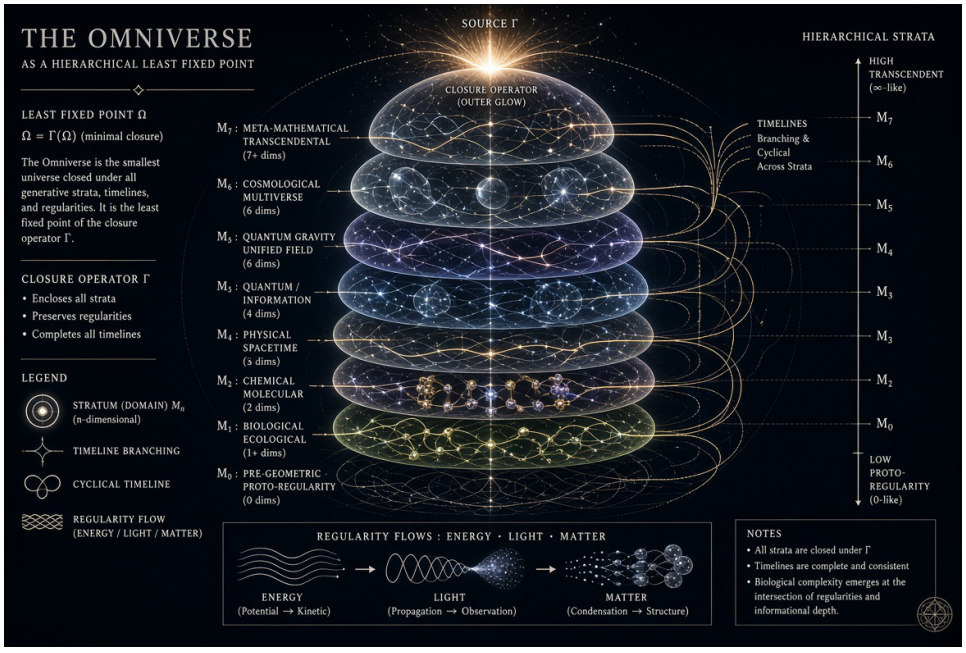
STRATIFIED SOURCE REALISM

THE ULTIMATE PUBLIC EDITION
A Unified Metaphysical Statement, Formal Core, and Illustrated Guide

Integrated from the original competition essay and three subsequent developed editions



Cover image: the original SSR cosmological hierarchy illustration, reproduced from the supplied competition essay.

Public-facing position. This edition presents SSR as a complete, coherent philosophical framework and states its central thesis decisively. It does not falsely label a metaphysical proposition as an empirically verified universal fact: the fixed-point theorem is established mathematics under stated assumptions; the claim that its fixed point is total reality remains the ontological interpretation defended by SSR.

Definitive Public Edition • Version 4.0 • 15 October 2026

Reader's guide and definitive statement

This volume consolidates four supplied documents: the original *Final Competition Essay*, the *Research Programme Development* document, *Research Programme v2.0*, and *Definitive Edition v3.0*. It preserves the originating thesis's central vocabulary and visual concepts while resolving contradictions that can be resolved from the documents themselves, clarifying those that cannot, and distinguishing formal results from philosophical commitments.

The phrase *Ultimate Public Edition* denotes the intended completeness and accessibility of this presentation, not proof that every metaphysical proposition has become a scientific fact. A framework can be presented as a finished philosophical position without pretending that its premises have been empirically confirmed.

The thesis in one paragraph

Stratified Source Realism proposes that the totality of reality, called the Omniverse O, is the least fixed point of a constrained generative operator Γ_C acting on a complete lattice of admissible structural objects. Its proposed ontology includes domains arranged by a partial order, directed restriction maps that preserve designated structure, temporal systems in which agency-supporting regularities may be recurrently recoverable, level-relative actuality, phenomenal character represented without claiming to solve the hard problem of consciousness, and value understood partly through the sustained availability of qualitative profiles. Source names the generative role represented by Γ_C. The equation gives SSR its formal core; the interpretation of that core as total reality is its central metaphysical thesis.

What is definitive here

• **One canonical equation:** O = μΓ_C, with Γ_C(O) = O.

• **One consistent vocabulary:** generation, admissibility, partial order, restriction, recoverability, timeline, actuality, phenomenal profile, and value are separated rather than conflated.

• **One epistemic standard:** theorem, definition, model assumption, metaphysical interpretation, and illustrative graphic are identified distinctly.

• **One public account:** the original diagrams are retained and explained; new diagrams provide clean, readable summaries.

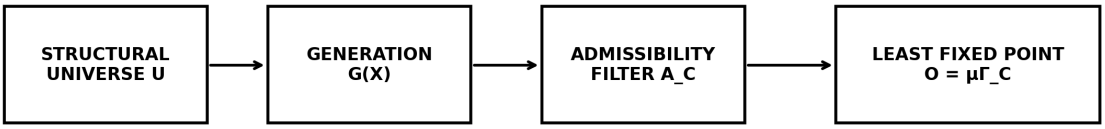
• **One honest boundary:** the document presents SSR as a complete position, but does not assert that the metaphysical identification has been independently verified as a universal empirical fact.

1. The central ontological claim

$$O = \mu\Gamma_C,\ \Gamma_C(O) = O$$

Let U be a specified set of admissible structural objects and let L = P(U), the powerset of U ordered by subset inclusion. L is a complete lattice. Let $\Gamma_C : L \to L$ be a monotone endofunction encoding the generative rules and admissibility constraints of SSR. The Knaster–Tarski fixed-point theorem guarantees that Γ_C has a least fixed point $\mu\Gamma_C$.

SSR identifies that least fixed point with O, the Omniverse: the totality of domains, regularities, timelines, and admissible extensions generated under the framework's rules. It identifies Source with the generative role of Γ_C. This is a substantive metaphysical interpretation, not an additional conclusion of the fixed-point theorem.



$$\Gamma_C(X) = G(X) \cap Adm_C$$

Required: Γ_C is well-typed and monotone on a complete lattice.

Mathematics establishes a least fixed point; the identification O = all actual reality is the metaphysical thesis.

Figure 1. Canonical architecture. A generation rule and a constraint predicate are combined into Γ_C. The theorem applies only if the resulting operator is well-typed, maps the lattice to itself, and is monotone.

The theorem and its scope

Mathematical result: a monotone endofunction on a complete lattice has a least fixed point. The least fixed point is unique as the least one, although other fixed points may exist.

Metaphysical interpretation: the Omniverse is that least fixed point and Source is its generative operator.

Not implied by the theorem: that U contains every actual entity; that Γ_C captures every actual law; that this is the only possible metaphysics; or that consciousness and value follow from fixed-point existence alone.

Canonical formulation. SSR is the thesis that reality is best understood as the least total structure closed under a specified, monotone, admissibility-preserving generative operator, with hierarchical recoverability and temporal persistence constraints included in the structure.

Why use a least fixed point?

The leastness condition encodes a non-arbitrary minimality claim: among all fixed points of the specified operator, $\mu\Gamma_C$ is contained in every other fixed point. It is therefore the smallest structure that satisfies the operator's fixed-point condition. This supports an internal notion of minimality; it does not by itself prove that the operator's input universe is exhaustive.

2. The generative operator, constraints, and closure

The original materials compress several different ideas into Γ_{≤,R,C}: a generative rule, a directed order, restriction maps, and a temporal constraint. For mathematical clarity, this edition distinguishes them while allowing them to be combined into one operator once their types are fixed.

$$\Gamma_C(X) = G(X) \cap \mathrm{Adm}_C$$

Here G is the generation function and Adm_C is the set of objects admissible under constraint C. This expression is valid as a simple model when Adm_C is a fixed subset of U and G is monotone. If admissibility depends on X, the filter must be defined more carefully and monotonicity must be proved rather than assumed.

Three properties that must not be confused

Monotonicity: X ⊆ Y implies Γ_C(X) ⊆ Γ_C(Y). This is the relevant condition for the Knaster–Tarski theorem.

Extensivity: X ⊆ Γ_C(X).

Idempotence: Γ_C(Γ_C(X)) = Γ_C(X).

In standard order theory, a closure operator satisfies all three. A merely monotone endofunction is not automatically a closure operator in this stronger sense. SSR may use 'constrained closure' in a broad conceptual sense, but should state the exact properties claimed in any formal argument.

Iterative construction

$$X_0 = \varnothing;\ X_{\alpha+1} = \Gamma_C(X_\alpha);\ X_\lambda = \bigcup_{\beta<\lambda} X_\beta$$

This is a schematic transfinite construction for an increasing chain when the operator's properties support it. Monotonicity alone does not guarantee convergence after finitely many or countably many iterations. Additional continuity assumptions can support convergence at ω; general monotone operators may require transfinite stages.

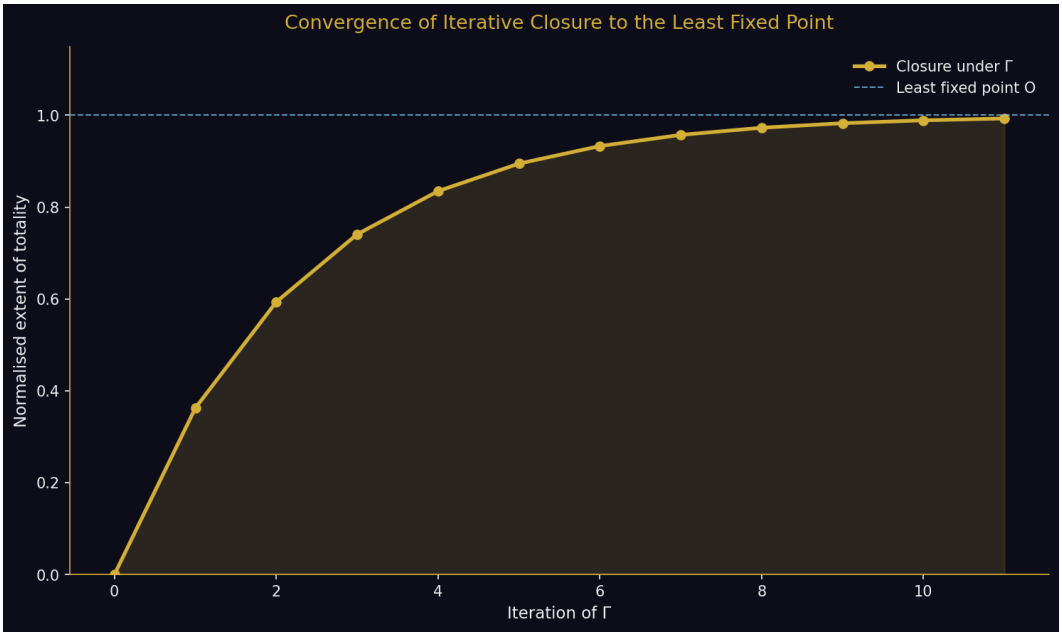


Figure 2. The original competition essay's convergence plot. It is an illustrative normalised curve, not empirical measurement and not a general proof that every monotone operator converges at that rate.

The graph communicates an intuition—successive generation may approach a stable totality—but the theorem itself is about existence of a least fixed point, not a particular numerical convergence curve.

3. The hierarchy of domains

The original thesis describes the Omniverse as stratified, with domains organised by regularity flows and linked by restriction. Its displayed labels are M7+, M6, M5, M4, M3, M2, M1, and M0. That is eight labels, although the source text calls them nine strata. The supplied documents do not specify an unambiguous ninth label. This edition therefore retains the eight stated labels and treats the claimed count of nine as unresolved rather than inventing a level.

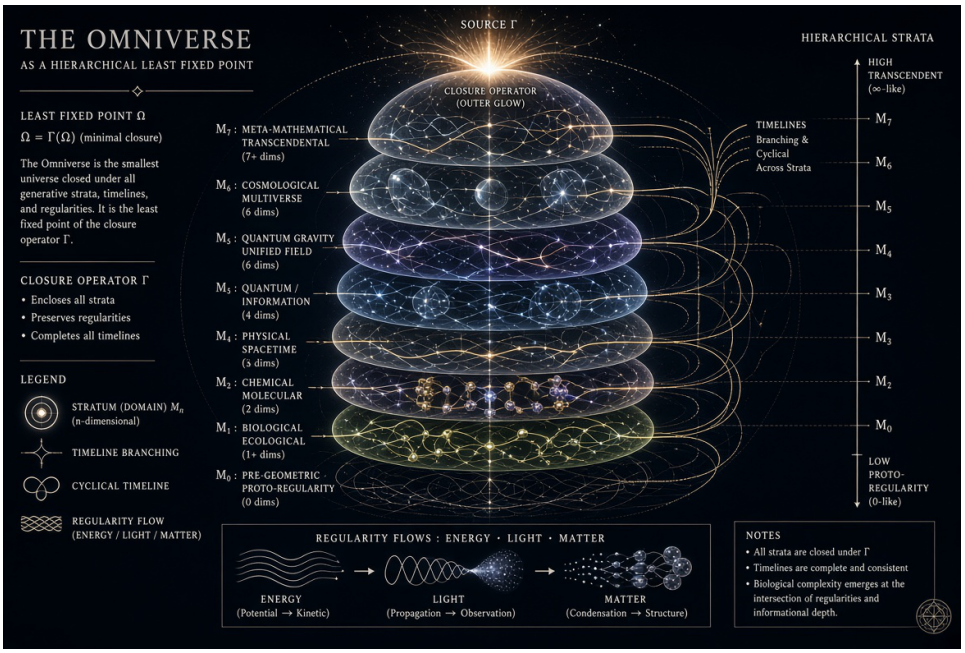


Figure 3. Original Omniverse hierarchy diagram from the competition essay, page 1. Nested layers portray proposed strata; side annotations represent timelines and regularity flows involving energy, light, and matter.

The provisional strata

Label	Proposed domain	Status in this edition
M7+	Meta-mathematical / transcendent	Proposed conceptual level
M6	Cosmological multiverse	Proposed conceptual level
M5	Quantum gravity / unified field	Proposed conceptual level
M4	Quantum / information	Proposed conceptual level
M3	Physical spacetime	Physical domain label; placement in this hierarchy remains theoretical
M2	Chemical / molecular	Domain label; hierarchy relation needs specification
M1	Biological / ecological	Domain label; agency-related discussion occurs here
M0	Pre-geometric proto-regularity	Proposed foundational conceptual level

The labels do not establish literal spatial dimensionalities. The hierarchy is best read as a proposed explanatory ordering of domains, not a verified ladder of physical dimensions. The model should use a partially ordered set of levels, allowing some domains to be incomparable, unless a total chain is independently justified.

$D_n \preccurlyeq D_m$ does not imply $|D_n| \subseteq |D_m|$

The relation between domains is structural, not automatically literal set inclusion. It should be induced by a declared criterion such as a designated map preserving a selected signature of relations.

4. Restriction, accessibility, and recoverability

SSR distinguishes inclusion from accessibility. Inclusion is intended to hold where a higher-indexed domain has a structure-preserving restriction map that recovers a lower domain. Accessibility is a structural relation between domains that need not imply inclusion or surjective recoverability.

K-Recoverable(D′ → D) ⇔ ∃r : D′ → D preserving every designated K-observable

A domain D has a signature Σ_D of relations and observables. A map r : D′ → D is a homomorphism when it preserves the selected signature. Surjectivity means every element of D is reached by r; it does not guarantee that every property of D′ is represented in D, and it does not make r invertible.

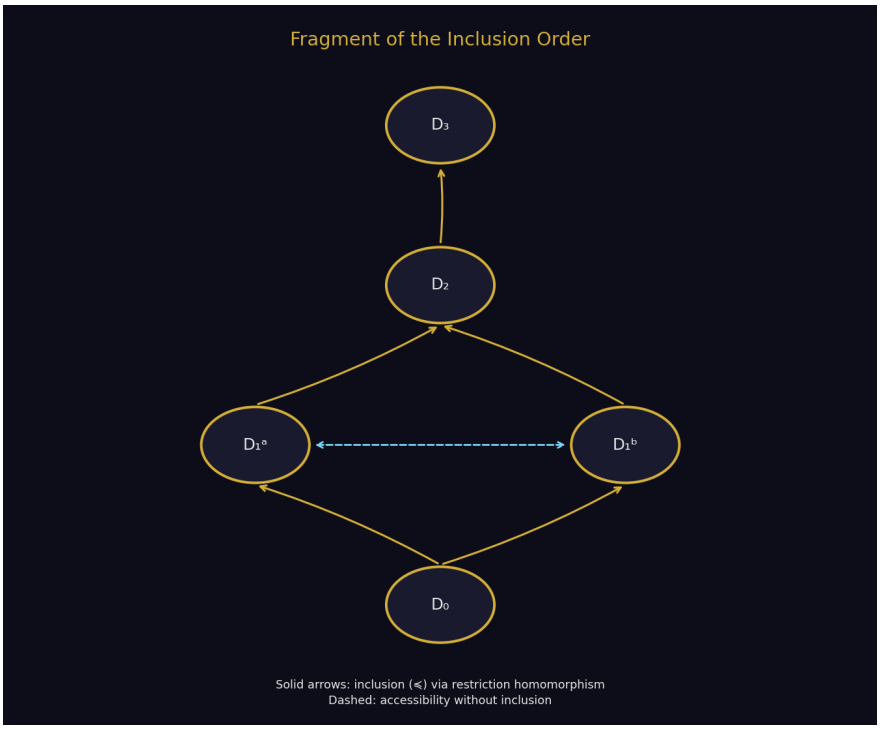


Figure 4. The original Hasse-style fragment of the inclusion partial order. Solid directed edges represent proposed inclusion/restriction relations; a dashed link represents accessibility without inclusion.

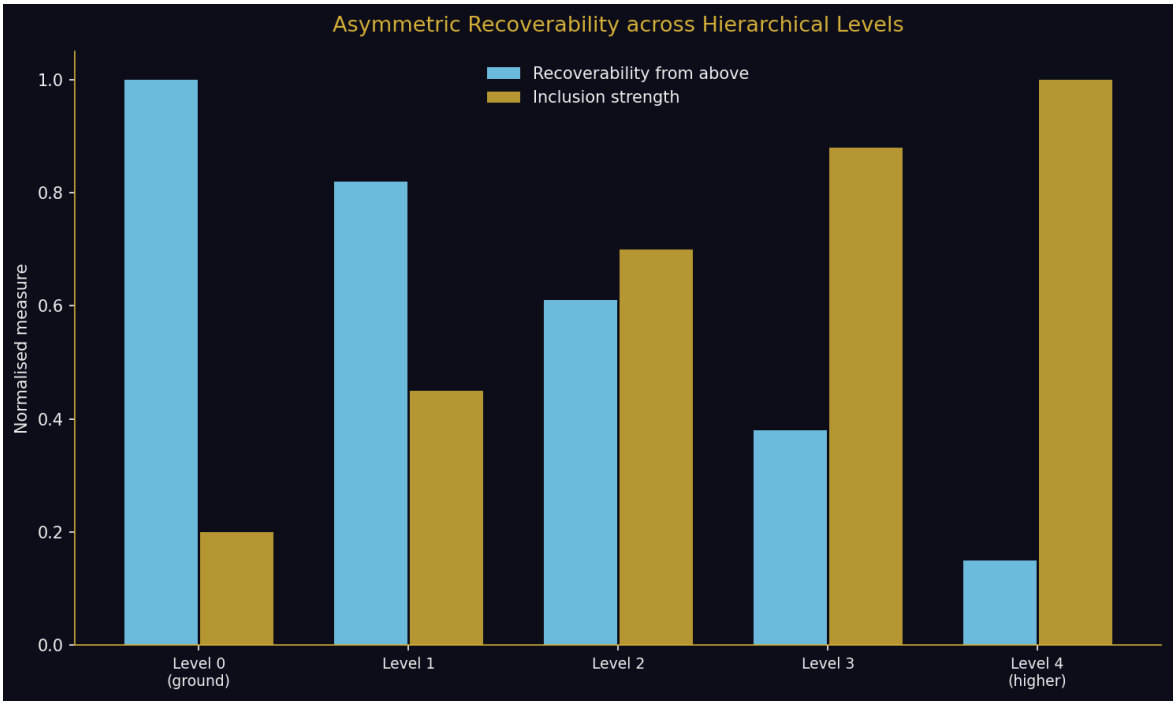


Figure 5. Original asymmetric-recoverability chart. Its normalised bars are illustrative conceptual values, not measured quantities. The chart depicts a proposed contrast between recoverability from higher structure and the strength of

inclusion.

Why asymmetry matters

The originating argument is that cross-level explanation requires more than a flat list of domains. Some facts may be recovered through structure-preserving restriction, enabling prediction or intervention, while other features are not represented in the lower-level vocabulary. SSR treats this asymmetry as ontological rather than merely representational.

This is a substantive argument, not a theorem. A rival flat ontology could add directed maps and intervention relations. SSR's comparative burden is to show that its hierarchy explains those relations more clearly or economically than alternatives.

5. Timelines and periodic recoverability

The original essay allows linear, branching, non-linear, parallel, and potentially non-well-founded temporal structures. It uses 'Zodiacal' to name a periodic-recoverability constraint: where an agency-supporting domain is embedded in a timeline, designated regularities should remain recoverable across temporal cycles.

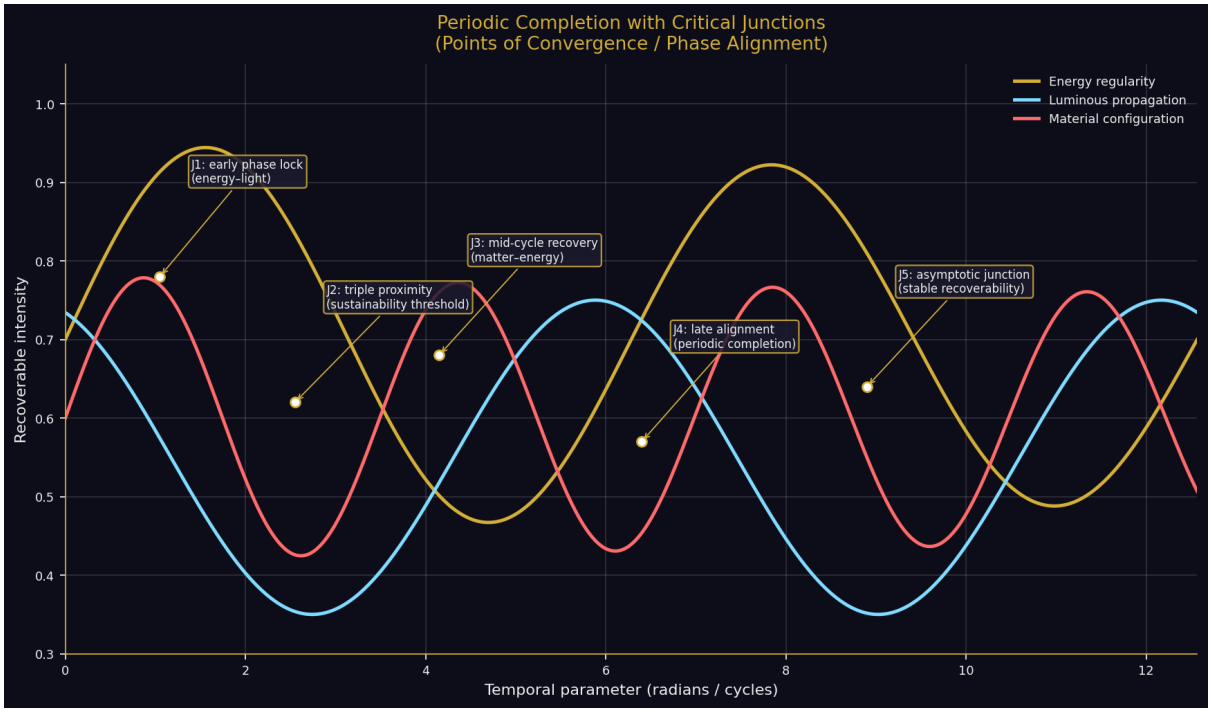
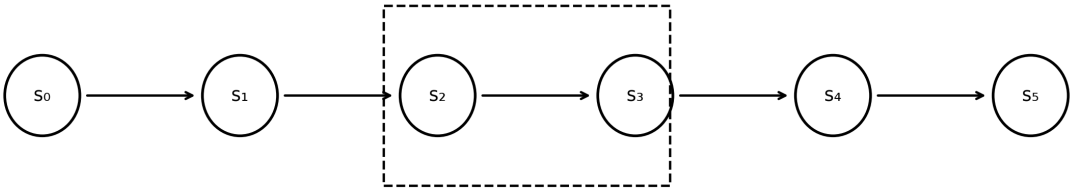


Figure 6. Original periodic-completion figure, with critical junctions and a stated difference threshold. The graphic is a conceptual schematic; it is not a measured physical time series.

$$T = (S, \tau)$$

A timeline is represented as a transition system with state space S and transition relation or evolution rule τ. Periodic recoverability can be expressed using an equivalence relation ~_C of finite index and designated observables f_i. For each observable, choose a metric d_i and tolerance ε_i:

$$d_i(f_i(s), f_i(s')) \leq \varepsilon_i \text{ whenever } s \sim_C s'$$



$$d_i(f_i(s), f_i(s')) \leq \varepsilon_i \text{ when } s \sim C\ s'$$

Finite-index ε-recoverability is a model condition—not proof of universal physical periodicity.

Figure 7. Clean schematic of a timeline as a transition system. Recurrent classes and ε-tolerant observables support re-identification in a specified model; they do not imply that all physical processes are exactly periodic.

What this condition means

The condition gives an operational template for approximate recurrence. A complete model must state which states are equivalent, which observables matter, how distances are measured, and what tolerances are acceptable. The existence of recurrence does not itself show that entropy is prevented from increasing, that thermodynamic reversibility occurs, or that all agency requires periodicity.

The strongest defensible SSR formulation is conditional: periodic recoverability may be a sufficient stability condition for specified agency-supporting systems. It is not established as a necessary condition for every conceivable form of persistence. Robust memory, feedback, and non-periodic dynamical stability are potential countercases that the framework must accommodate.

6. Energy, light, matter, and regularity flows

Across the supplied materials, energy, light, and matter are treated as domain-relative regularities that can be recovered under restriction. The original hierarchy graphic depicts a flow from energy through light to matter, including biological matter. These terms function as conceptual anchors in SSR, but the source documents do not derive physical laws or constants from Γ_C.

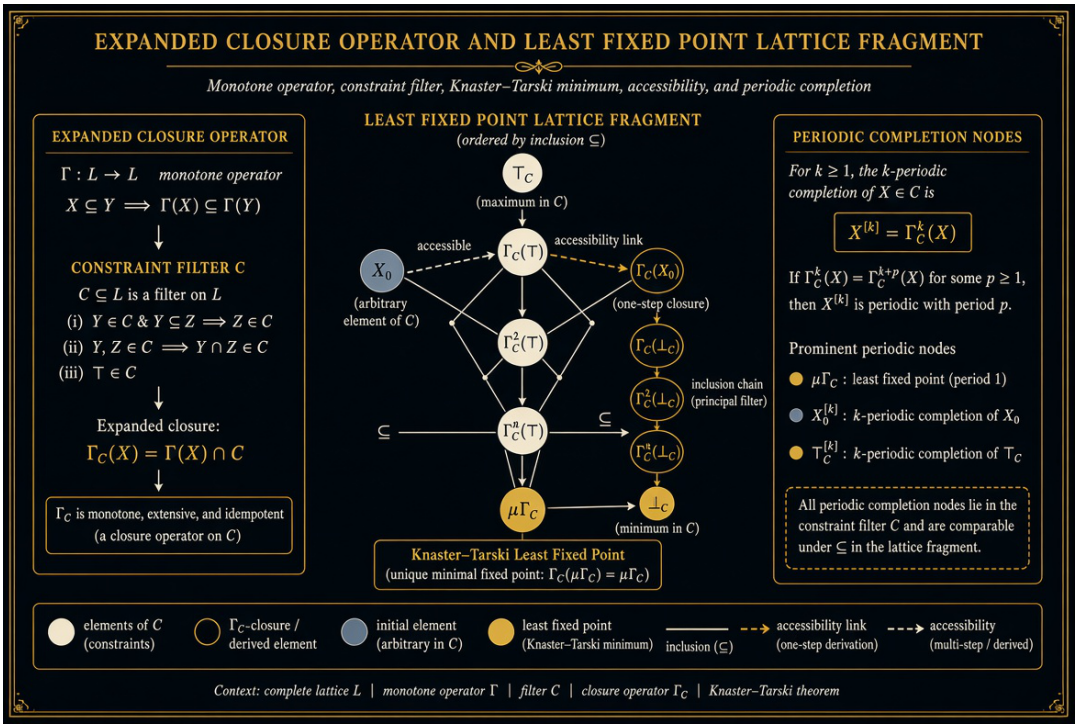


Figure 8. Original closure-operator and constraint-filter lattice figure. Its visual language connects a monotone operator, constraint C, and a least fixed point; the formal validity depends on the conditions stated in Sections 1–2.

Cross-level constants

SSR calls restriction-invariant patterns cross-level constants. In a formal model, this should mean a property or observable preserved by the relevant family of restriction maps. The term does not automatically mean a universal physical constant such as a measured coupling or cosmological parameter.

The ontology can treat physical laws as clauses within the generative rule-system, but this is a philosophical account of lawhood. It does not replace physics' empirical work of measuring, testing, and refining laws.

7. Actuality and indexicality

The original thesis argues that actuality is level-relative: what is actual is framed by an actuality operator Act_n. It further proposes that a correct judgment at level n belongs to higher enclosing domains when the relevant structure is recoverable. The formal challenge is to state compatibility across levels without treating every truth at one level as automatically true at all others.

$$\mathbf{Act_n : D_n \rightarrow \Phi_n}$$

Here Φ_n is the representational space of actuality-relevant states or propositions at level n. Let r_{m,n} be a restriction map and q_{m,n} a translation between representational spaces. A proposed coherence condition is:

$$\mathbf{Act_n(r_\{m,n\}(x)) = q_\{m,n\}(Act_m(x))}$$

This equation is a formal proposal for compatible representations, not a theorem supplied by the original thesis. It is meaningful only when the maps and their domains are explicitly defined.

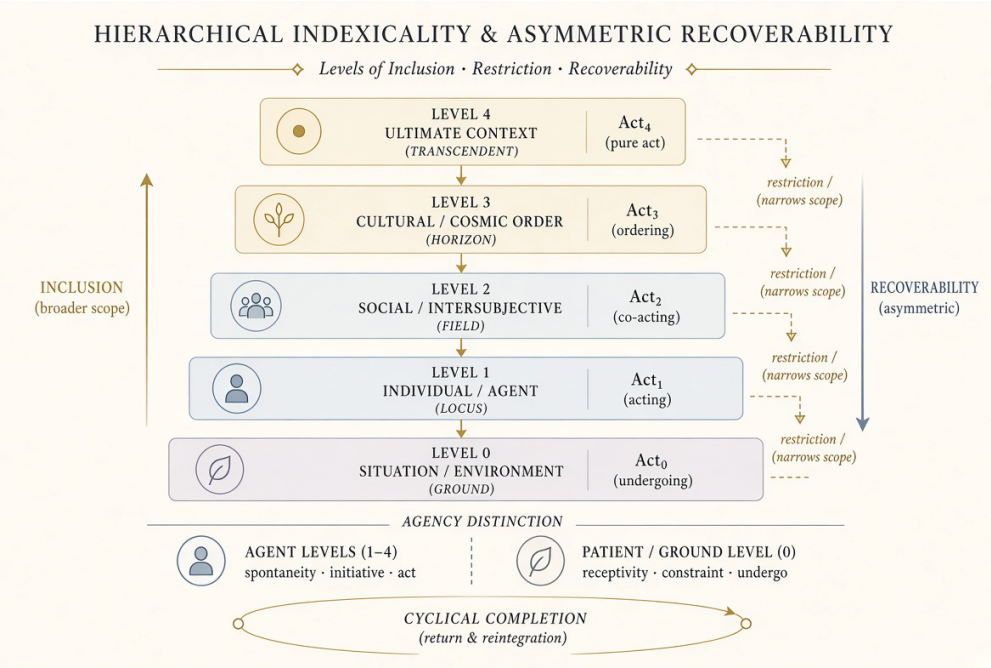


Figure 9. Original hierarchical-indexicality diagram from the competition essay. It illustrates local actuality and cross-level representation; it does not prove that all lower-level judgments remain true at every higher level.

8. Agency, phenomenal character, and consciousness

SSR locates phenomenal character—what-it-is-like experience—as level-relative and indexical, associated in the original thesis with biological metabolic cycles and with a stable distinction between a local state and its context. The later versions clarify that a formal representation of a qualitative profile does not itself explain subjective experience.

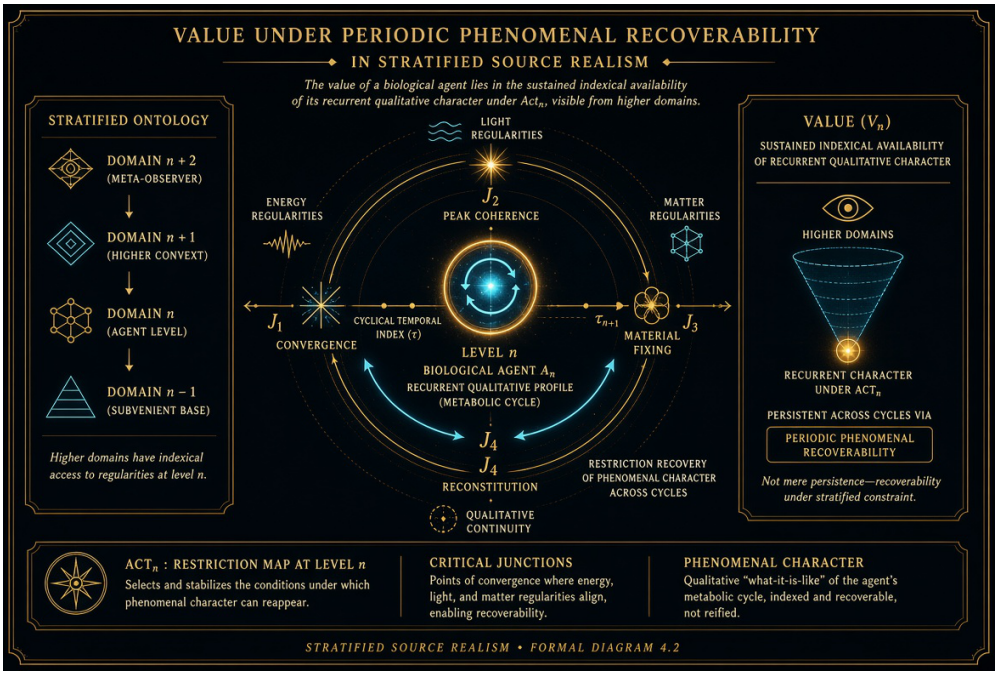


Figure 10. Original phenomenal-character diagram. It depicts qualitative re-identification across hierarchical and temporal relations, as conceptualised by SSR.

A disciplined account of agency

For purposes of modelling, an agency-capable domain may be specified as one with (i) an internal state distinguishable from context, (ii) memory or state retention, (iii) control or action selection, and (iv) temporally extended behaviour. This is a proposed operational definition for analysis, not a claim that every system satisfying it is conscious.

SSR's structural proposal is that phenomenal profiles may be re-identified across permitted restrictions and, where agency-supporting timelines require it, across recurrent temporal classes. The framework does not derive intrinsic qualitative character from the fixed-point operator and does not claim to have solved the hard problem of consciousness.

Public statement: SSR offers a structural account of where phenomenal character belongs in its ontology and how it may be represented across domains and time. It does not establish that structural recoverability is identical to consciousness.

9. Value and meaning

The original essay defines value in terms of the continued indexical availability of qualitative character under Act_n, recoverable across levels and temporal junctions. Meaning is the level-relative realisation of value by agents that maintain a stable distinction between internal state and context.

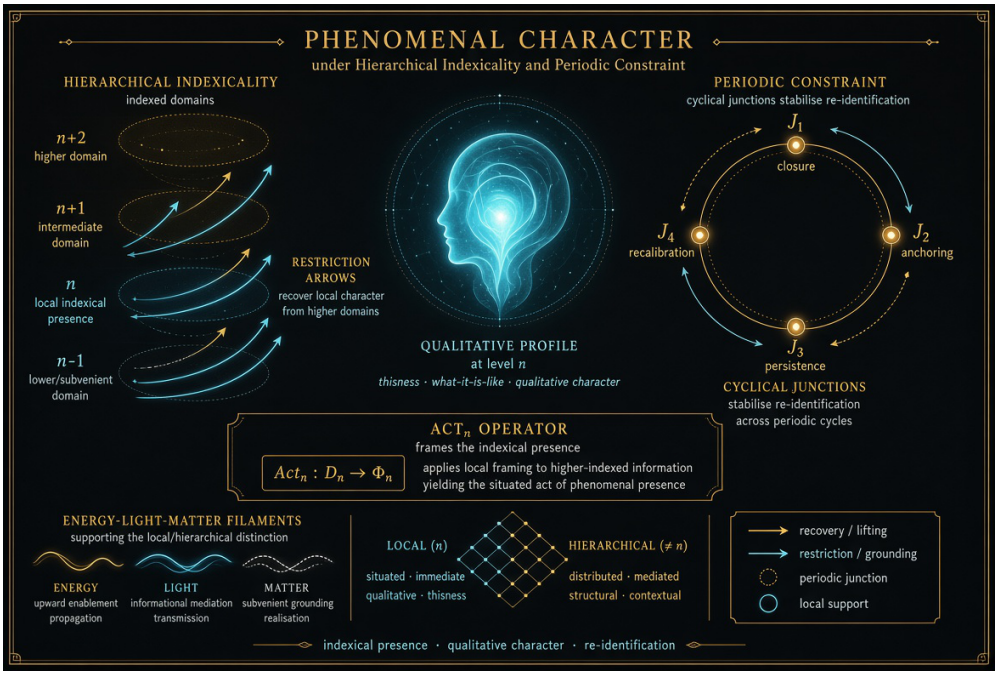


Figure 11. Original value diagram. It portrays persistence of a qualitative profile across critical junctions as valuable within SSR's account; the image is conceptual, not a validated welfare measurement.



Illustrative representation: V(h) = $\int_0^T$ w(t) A_Q(t) dt

The metric needs independent normative choices; persistence alone does not settle moral value.

Figure 12. A compact representation of the proposed relation between qualitative profile, re-identification, and value.

$$\mathbf{V(h) = \int_0^T w(t)\ A_Q(t)\ dt}$$

This illustrative functional represents weighted availability A_Q(t) of a qualitative profile along a history h. It is not a validated universal measure of value. Any complete normative interpretation must explain the weight function w(t), whose experiences count, how suffering and benefit are compared, and whether continued persistence is valuable in every case.

SSR's contribution is a proposal that sustained recoverability is one structural condition for continued valuation. It should not be read as the claim that mere persistence is always good, or that value can be settled without normative premises.

10. Source, origin, and laws

The original essay states that there is no exterior origin and that the foundational laws are precisely the clauses defining the operator. The later programme clarifies that identifying Source with Γ_C is an internal ontological identification and a claim of comparative minimality, not a proof that every alternative metaphysics is impossible.

Within SSR, Source is not introduced as a second object outside the Omniverse. It names the generative role that determines the operator's admissible extensions. The least-fixed-point picture is intended to avoid an unexplained external starting point by defining totality through internal closure.

The explanatory price is that the operator and its admissibility conditions must be specified. If the operator is simply defined to generate everything that exists, the account risks becoming circular or vacuous. SSR becomes informative when its rules constrain what is generated, preserve a nontrivial order, and support explanations or distinctions not inserted by hand.

Comparative minimality

The central defence is comparative: SSR seeks a single framework that jointly represents exhaustiveness, asymmetric recoverability, hierarchical indexicality, non-arbitrariness, and the structural possibility of sustainable agency. Its claim is not that the operator is the only imaginable formalism, but that the combined criteria may favour its architecture over rivals.

11. Comparison with other metaphysical frameworks

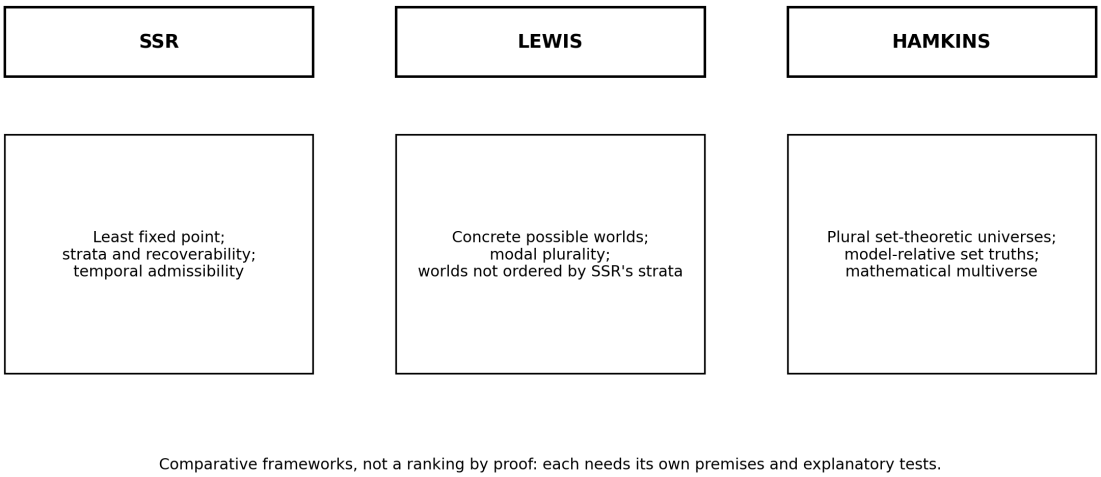


Figure 13. Conceptual comparison of the frameworks' principal organising ideas. The diagram is a guide, not a verdict that SSR has been proved superior.

David Lewis's modal realism

Lewis's modal realism gives a central place to concrete possible worlds and modal plurality. SSR's distinctive emphasis is directed cross-level recoverability, a constrained generative totality, and temporal admissibility tied to agency-supporting domains. This difference is not a refutation of Lewis. SSR must show that its additional structure provides explanatory gains that a Lewisian framework with suitable relations could not match at lower cost.

Joel David Hamkins's set-theoretic multiversism

Hamkins's set-theoretic multiverse explores plural set-theoretic universes and the variety of model-relative set-theoretic truths. SSR proposes a wider structural universe of domains, maps, and timelines, rather than restricting its subject matter to models of set theory. The comparison is one of scope and explanatory aim; neither fixed-point mathematics nor the existence of multiple set-theoretic models settles SSR's ontological interpretation.

The comparative test

SSR should be judged by conceptual coherence, mathematical precision, ontological cost, explanatory reach, compatibility with successful science, treatment of counterexamples, and whether its extra structure yields genuine insight. A larger unifying picture is not automatically truer; its additional commitments must earn their place.

12. Objections and definitive replies

Objection A: Source merely renames the unexplained

Reply: SSR treats Source as the internal generative role of Γ_C rather than an external entity. This can avoid a separate external origin, but only if the operator's rules are substantive and non-circular. The position is a proposed explanatory stopping point, not a proof that no alternative stopping point is possible.

Objection B: Hierarchy is imposed, not discovered

Reply: SSR motivates hierarchy through asymmetric recoverability and intervention-relevant maps. That is a coherent explanatory proposal. It does not follow that every flat ontology is inadequate, since a flat ontology might also include directed relations. SSR's advantage is comparative, not a logical impossibility theorem against all alternatives.

Objection C: Periodicity is not universal

Reply: The mature formulation does not require exact periodicity of every physical process. It uses finite-index, ε-tolerant recoverability as a condition for specified agency-supporting timelines. Whether this condition is necessary, sufficient, or replaceable is domain-dependent; SSR's public formulation treats it as a proposed stability principle.

Objection D: Recoverability does not explain consciousness

Reply: Correct. SSR gives phenomenal character a structural and indexical role without claiming to derive the intrinsic qualitative nature of experience. This is a deliberate limitation, not a completed solution to the hard problem.

Objection E: The fixed-point theorem cannot prove total reality

Reply: Correct. The theorem proves a conditional result about a formal operator on a complete lattice. The claim that the resulting fixed point is the totality of reality is SSR's metaphysical thesis. The framework is stronger when this boundary is stated explicitly rather than blurred.

13. Canonical formal appendix

Definition 1 — Structural universe

U is a specified set of candidate structural objects, including domains, relations, timelines, maps, and labelled observables.

Definition 2 — Complete lattice

L = P(U), ordered by ⊆, is a complete lattice: every family of subsets has a meet and a join.

Definition 3 — Monotone generation operator

Γ_C : L → L is monotone iff for all X,Y ∈ L, X ⊆ Y implies Γ_C(X) ⊆ Γ_C(Y). The operator includes generation rules and admissibility constraints.

Definition 4 — Least fixed point

O = μΓ_C is the least element among all X ∈ L satisfying Γ_C(X) = X.

Definition 5 — Structural domain

A domain is a structured object D = (|D|, R_D, Obs_D), where |D| is its carrier, R_D its designated relations, and Obs_D its observables.

Definition 6 — Restriction and recoverability

A restriction map r : D′ → D preserves a declared signature K. K-recoverability is relative to that signature; surjectivity is an additional property, not automatic.

Definition 7 — Timeline and recurrence

A timeline is T = (S,τ). Periodic recoverability requires a specified finite-index equivalence relation ∼_C and metrics d_i over observables f_i such that d_i(f_i(s),f_i(s′)) ≤ ε_i for equivalent states.

Definition 8 — Actuality representation

Act_n : D_n → Φ_n assigns level-relative actuality representations. Cross-level compatibility requires explicitly defined translation maps.

Definition 9 — Phenomenal profile and value

Q is a formal placeholder for a qualitative profile. V is a proposed functional over histories, interpreted only with explicit normative assumptions.

Theorem — Knaster–Tarski

If L is a complete lattice and Γ_C : L → L is monotone, then Γ_C has a least fixed point μΓ_C. This theorem is established mathematics.

Corollary within the model

Once U and Γ_C are fully specified, the model's least fixed point is mathematically determined. Whether it represents all actual reality is a separate interpretive premise.

Claims not established by the theorem

- That the chosen U exhausts all actual reality.
- That the constraint filter is monotone without proof.
- That the original hierarchy is physically complete or contains exactly nine strata.
- That periodic recoverability is necessary for all agency.
- That a formal qualitative profile explains subjective experience.
- That sustained persistence alone determines moral value.

14. Public conclusion

Stratified Source Realism presents a unified metaphysical vision: totality is conceived as the least structure closed under constrained generation; domains are related by a partial order and structure-preserving maps; temporal regularities support recoverability where agency depends on them; actuality is indexical across levels; phenomenal character occupies a formal place without being reduced to a mathematical symbol; and value is connected to the sustained availability of qualitative profiles.

Its strongest formal core is clear and durable: monotonicity on a complete lattice guarantees a least fixed point. Its strongest philosophical claim is that this fixed-point architecture is a compelling account of totality because it integrates exhaustiveness, asymmetric recoverability, temporal persistence, and agency-related structure within one scheme.

This public edition states that thesis as a complete position, while maintaining the distinction that makes it intellectually credible: formal validity is not the same as empirical verification, and mathematical existence is not by itself metaphysical exhaustiveness. SSR can therefore be presented decisively without claiming evidence that the supplied documents do not contain.

Definitive thesis statement: Stratified Source Realism identifies the Omniverse with the least fixed point of a monotone, constrained generative operator over a complete lattice of admissible structures. It interprets Source as the generative role of that operator and treats hierarchical recoverability, temporal stability, indexical actuality, phenomenal profile, and value as connected dimensions of the resulting ontology. The fixed-point result is mathematically valid under its stated conditions; the identification of that result with total reality is the defining metaphysical commitment of SSR.

Selected references and source record

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